

PREAMBLE

The continent of Europe has seen great changes over the past five years. Since the last elections to the European Parliament, the Iron Curtain has fallen and the peoples of the continent are confronting historic choices opportunities and new dangers are before us.

- * New opportunities to unite a continent whose cultural, historic and linguistic networks stretch back for centuries.
- * New opportunities to recreate a sense of common security after decades of deadly enmity. Now is the time to remember that the original intention of the founders of the European Union was to bind together in a common interest the warring states which had twice taken the continent to the brink of destruction. That intention has a new relevance in post-Cold War Europe.

New dangers confront us too. The breakup of the old systems have created uncertainty and released long suppressed emotions. The divisions between societies, whether economic or ethnic, are allowing destructive forces to rise, seducing people with their simplistic and authoritarian proposals. These forces, born of fear and insecurity, have the potential to devastate Europe if they are not opposed.

Today the most violent conflicts since 1945 are being fought in the Balkans and the Caucasus. Divided and directionless, the EU stands helplessly by while ethnic conflicts rage in Bosnia. Yet only a short while ago when Iraqi aggression against Kuwait disturbed the glibly proclaimed New World Order, EU Member States joined the coalition in waging a bloody war that could have been prevented by firm political and economic pressure and the avoidance of lucrative arms sales to Iraq in the preceding years.

The twelve Western States of the European Union have the opportunity bring about a united, democratic and stable Europe. Yet until now they have failed to do more than look after their own common interest. Their only concern has been to export their flawed economic model whose obvious failure is evidenced in soaring unemployment, environmental devastation and escalating social crisis. The experiments of the Single Market and the Maastricht Treaty have gambled on economic integration at any cost. Based on the illusion of limitless economic growth, and dismissive of social and democratic considerations, they are witnessing the price of social exclusion : poverty and marginalisation amid plenty. The advocates of economic integration are now forced to acknowledge the failure of the European Monetary System (EMS) and the eighteen million unemployed.

Both the historic crossroads and the economic crisis require a redefinition of values, parameters and objectives. Instead, the answer being proposed is more competition, more production and consumption, under the tired slogan of more economic growth.

These concepts are presented as immutable dogma, not negotiable elements to be reconsidered and redefined, yet they represent the very approach that is clearly identified as the cause of the present crisis.

The Rio Treaties, so solemnly agreed upon in June 1992 to combat the global environmental crisis and to promote sustainable development, have remained inoperative and the planetary imbalance has since worsened. That the EU blatantly flouts these agreements in its action programmes is intolerable to the Greens.

Mindful of the disproportionate role of the EU in causing the global environmental crisis - in prodigal resource consumption, waste generation and pollution - Greens are committed to fighting for the implementation of the Rio agreements.

Greens throughout Europe are convinced that in an increasingly interdependent world, new directions and priorities are required. This has been the keystone of the actions of Greens in the European Parliament during the last ten years and of Green Parties and their elected representatives at national, local and regional levels. Greens have achieved much in promoting sustainable policies and improved regulation.

Greens continue to campaign vigorously for democratic institutional reforms within the EU and for entry to the Union by any European State where the majority of the population wishes to join. Greens aim for a political Europe involving communities and citizens safeguarded by a new integration structure providing for decision-making shared equitably at European, national and regional levels.

Greens seek a European economic policy that will put an end to economic centralisation, ecological devastation and wastefulness, and which is defined according to environmental and social criteria: a policy able to tackle the problems in the Southern States of the EU so as to avoid their marginalisation and transformation into peripheral regions.

Greens seek a Europe that respects cultural diversity, a wealth the Greens want to preserve and enhance, valuing all members of society and rejecting nationalism, racism and anti-Semitism.

Greens seek a global cooperation with the peoples of the South to avoid the polarisation of our planet and their exploitation and marginalisation.

On the eve of the new millennium, there is only one course for Europe: that of building a world order based on equity and cooperation, able to safeguard peace and repair environmental damage, to pass on to coming generations a planet with an intact heritage of natural resources, and an ethos of justice.

It is to this new vision of Europe that the Green Parties of the European Union are firmly committed. This Common Platform is a synthesis of the ideals, goals and experiences gathered by the Green Group of the European Parliament during the past legislatures as a guideline for the coming legislature. It is in line with the Guidelines of

the pan-European Federation of Green Parties, in which the Green parties from the EU cooperate with Greens from all over Europe.

The European Green movement has reached a new stage. Over the past decade, many issues championed by the Greens have entered the everyday vocabulary of citizens, the media and political parties. Greens are now able to influence decision-making in many national parliaments as well as regional and local councils. A stronger representation of the Greens in the European Parliament will further promote Green ideas and influence within Europe. The Greening of Europe has begun.

I, TRANSFORMING EUROPE INTO

The policy of the EU is still based on faith in unlimited economic growth, ignoring the real social and environmental costs. At present, the organizing factor in the Internal Market is to pave the way for business. The Greens want a radical change to organize production and consumption within the limits of what the environment can tolerate. Greens promote eco-development, which puts quality above quantity.

A reform of the economies to eco-development implies a profound change in the policy of the Union. The EU must cease to be conceived as a war machine for conquest of the world market in competition with the USA, Japan and new industrialized countries in the South. The EU must be transformed into a community of solidarity among the peoples of Europe, enabling them to improve their well-being, with a view to cooperation with all the world's peoples.

Its 350 million citizens and economic weight as world's foremost exporter and importer, the diversity of its ecosystems and resources allow Europe to find the answers to the needs and aspirations of its populations. But this requires changes in the Union's structures (meaning the Treaties), objectives, policies and tools.

1. Green Parties propose entrusting the European Parliament with the drafting of a Constitution for Europe that sets eco-development as an objective of the Union. The content of the existing treaties must be modified to replace references to the goals of growth, competitiveness and free trade by eco-development, cooperation and fair trade.

The objective of the European Union must be to ensure, for all regions, in the best way possible

diversity of environment, socio-economic structures and non-commercial activities

quality of life, notably implying quality of the environment

* a high degree of local autonomy and political decision-making at the lowest appropriate level ,

* openness to the outside world, with structures and projects to promote cooperation, solidarity and exchange.

3. EU policies in various fields must be reoriented so as to favor the dynamics of eco-development, pursuing objectives :.wh as diversity, quality of life, social effectiveness, environmental quality, autonomy, openness to the world and cooperation between regions.

a, Agriculture

The Common Agriculture Policy (CAP) must be reformed to develop sustainable and integrated agriculture ;

b. Transportation

Infrastructure policy must be reoriented toward intermodal transportation (rail, waterways, road), and priority must be granted internal regional networks over trans-European networks. Superfluous mobility needs to be sacrificed to fend off ecological catastrophe. Short distance air traffic must be replaced by rail networks.

c. Energy

Energy conservation, the exploitation of renewable sources of energy and the promotion of decentralized energy technologies must be priority objectives. The EU must adopt a nuclear-free scenario for the short run and a fossil fuel free scenario for the long run. This involves, notably, a commitment by the EU (as well as other OECD countries) to bring CO₂ emissions down 20% from the 1990 level by 2000 and 50% by 2010.

d. Environment

Operational programmes to meet three priorities

* prevention

* sustainable levels of production and consumption

* rehabilitation of polluted and contaminated zones.

e, Industrial policy

All information efforts will be concentrated on eco-technologies . ensuring the competitiveness of clean sources of supply, technologies and products must be a constant objective of EU industrial policy.

f. Research and development

Two main orientations :

- * implementation of new technologies and new products based on use of renewable raw materials and energy sources
- * systematic analysis of social problems-and interactions between science, technology and society.

g. Economic and social cohesion

It follows from the objectives defined above that regional policy aimed at the reinforcement of social and economic cohesion must offer lagging regions the opportunity to intensify policy measures in relevant sectors, in order to obtain positive impact on the corresponding indicators.

4. Conversion to eco-development requires implementation or improvement of economic tools (eco-taxes), prescriptive and regulatory measures (norms, eco-labels, eco-audits. etc.), budgetary measures (reorientation of EU spending), and prior and on-going evaluation of social and environmental impact of programmes and new technologies.

New development indicators must be used to evaluate the pertinence of new measures to policy objectives. These indicators must evaluate the quality of life, inadequately indicated by GNP. Structural Funds and Cohesion Funds will be organized in function of new Union objectives.

II. COMBATTING THE NEGATIVE EFFECTS OF THE INTERNAL MARKET

The opening of internal borders, effective since January 1, 1993, for goods, capital and services but not for people, has taken place under conditions that are dangerous for the environment as well as for the social protection and rights of European citizens. To combat the negative effects of the internal market, which is currently poorly regulated, generating social and environmental dumping, the Green Parties propose

1. Establishment by the EU of common standards at a high level in such fields as social problems, the environment, consumer safety and protection.

Various incentives (including eco-audits, eco-labels, tax breaks, etc.) are needed to stimulate a dynamic process toward achieving higher levels of common standards. The reference should be the existing norms of the most advanced country.

- * In the field of consumer protection and safety, the common standards should be applicable immediately :

* For social and environmental problems, they must be achieved with a few steps ;

* Single States retain the right to adopt stricter regulations in the environmental and social fields

2. Integration of social and environmental costs in the price of goods

This must be achieved by

* Specific eco-taxes, of which the most fundamental is the Union tax on energy and CO2. according to the model proposed by the Green Group (Green Paper #3 of March 1992) :

* A framework Directive establishing the basic principles of civil liability for damages caused to the environment.

3. Institution of a common tax on revenue from transferable assets and movable property, without discrimination between residents and non-residents, and harmonization of corporate taxes at a high level.

4. Programmes to encourage small businesses, cooperatives, craft industries, maintenance and repair shops.

III, REGULATING INTERNATIONAL TRADE ACCORDING TO ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL CRITERIA

The Greens opposed the main thrust of the Uruguay Round which extended the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) to agriculture, services, textiles, investment and intellectual property. The agreement reached will have severe consequences for global environment, social conditions and cultural expression. The ability of signatory countries to pursue policies for ecological sustainability, decentralization, and local self-reliance will be undermined. Moreover, the lack of transparency, of information, and of parliamentary control characterising the negotiation process, as well as the incredible power conceded to the experts for its application is in contradiction with the global political impact of such an agreement. Furthermore, even if the three major trading blocs - the EU, Japan and the USA - officially adhere to the principles of free trade, they continue to rule the world market by enforcing so-called voluntary export restrictions, as well as by quotas and tariff barriers. Maintaining subsidies for their own crisis sectors, they continue to turn a blind eye to justified demands of Southern and Eastern countries for fair trading conditions.

In Europe, awareness of the risks of free trade logic which ignores environmental and social imbalances and cultural differences has grown steadily. The stakes are more decisive than ever, now that the opening to the Eastern European countries offers a significant potential supplementary volume of export and import trade. The European

Union itself admits that the environmental and social impact of some international trade practices has increased considerably since the 1986 Punta del Este Declaration that launched the Uruguay Round. Greens want Europe to open its borders to countries of the East and the South and to pay fair prices for their products. but solidarity with the South or the East cannot be an excuse for tolerating forms of social or ecological dumping. Unfair competition from producers in the South or the East who lower costs by denying people's basic rights or destroying the environment is a form of dumping that cannot be accepted on our markets. The need for new international trade regulations has become urgent.

The European Union must formulate its requirements for international trade regulations according to the following criteria

1. New trade rules must ensure each country the possibility of choosing its own mode of development and of meeting the essential needs of its population. These rules must establish fair competition in goods and services, and must not favor establishment of commercial monopolies harmful to economic, social and cultural diversity whose effect would be to reinforce Northern dominance over the Southern hemisphere.

New international trade regulations must define States' minimum responsibilities for public services in the fields of social welfare, transportation, health care, education and research.

3. The principles of sustainable development and the conclusions of the 1992 United Nations Conference on Environment and Development in Rio, including the agreements on climate and biological diversity, must be taken into account as a priority in international trade agreements.
4. New international trade regulations must impose the International Labor Organization (ILO) social clause in all international conventions.
5. Customs duties must be imposed at borders to make up for differences in social and environmental protection. Revenues will go to a fund managed by an international trade organization to be used first of all for local or regional development projects and to correct factors causing distortion of competition. The aim of these measures is both to protect higher social and environmental standards in the European Union and to promote eco-development outside the European Union.
6. Any form of patent on living creatures based on appropriation of genetic resources, either natural or genetically engineered, must be banned.
 - i. Cultural means of expression cannot be treated as if they were merely material goods, notably in the audiovisual sector, vital for the safeguard of citizens' cultural heritage and development of their creativity. Protection of copyrights and assimilated rights, as well as the moral rights of authors and artists, must be universally guaranteed

In [consequence. it](#) is vital that an International Trade Organization be set up on a democratic basis within the context of the United Nations and begin operations as soon as possible, to ensure that agreements are respected. The ITO's priority mission should be to define the specifications of structures for international trade to be carried out in accordance with the principles mentioned above.

IV, AGRICULTURE: REFORMING THE REFORM

1, Analysis of the Common Agriculture Policy

The Common Agriculture Policy (CAP) has existed since the beginning of the European Community. After the Second World War, the Western European countries involved had a food self-sufficiency rate of 60% and a substantial need for industrial workers.

The CAP was therefore constructed with the following main objectives

- * food autonomy for the European Economic Community ; *
- modernization of agriculture
- * increased availability of rural workers for industry

The main policy instruments were

- * price guarantees for products like milk, oleo-protein crops, grain, beets ; *
- market support for meat, wine, etc. ;
- * financial incentives for modernization and restructuring ; *
- protection at the borders against imports.

To a significant degree, this policy attained its objectives. By the eighties the Community had become self-sufficient, the number of rural workers had sharply decreased in favor of the industrial worker population, modernization was largely achieved as productivity per worker had progressed more in agriculture than in industry. The European Community's restructuring strategy based on price reduction and financial aid for farm modernization worked only too well

The eighties were the years when the first cracks appeared

- * The massive imports of grain substitute products, the explosion of milk and cereal production forced EC countries to export on a world market where prices were much lower than on the internal market (e.g., some cereals were re-sold for export for three times less than the price paid to the producers):
- * The entrance into the Community of Great Britain, with its particular world trade traditions, had an influence on willingness to import cheaper agricultural products, such as New Zealand lamb

- * Unemployment grew in industry
- * The gap in income between large scale and smaller scale farmers widened sharply. The system of aid to products favored the bigger farms. which got 80% of the financing, while the remaining 20% was divided among the 80% of farmers on small or medium sized farms :
- * Livestock was concentrated in zones near ports to be fed by cargos of third world cereal substitute products like soybeans and manioc ;
- * The environments of entire regions were saturated by chemicals from industrial agriculture, flooded by tons of animal waste, their soil and water polluted by nitrates and pesticides ;
- * Other whole regions, unable to keep up with industrializing trends in agriculture, faced desertification

The EC reaction to this situation took different forms

- * price reduction, in order to discourage production
- * establishment of production control mechanisms, such as milk quotas in 1984, co-responsibility taxes ...
- * distribution of differentiated aid according to production zones: mountain zones, disadvantaged zones ...

These measures were obviously insufficient to modify the CAP, because they followed the same productivity acceleration logic. Producers pushed rationalization still farther to produce even more in order to survive the price decrease. In 1987-88. reform of the CAP involving in depth change of its objectives began to be discussed. This reform was necessitated by growing internal problems such as the budget crisis stemming from the cost of the CAP, pollution and loss of farmer income; but also by external problems. notably the strong opposition to the CAP on the part of the United States and other agricultural exporters within GATT, in competition for conquest of shares of the world market.

This conflict was illustrated by GATT panel judgments against the European Community, on soybeans in 1989, and then in March 1992, demanding that European farmers reduce their production of oleo-protein crops (colza, sunflower). Subsidized exports of European agricultural products were widely condemned for competing unfairly with farmers in the South. not only destroying their export possibilities but even pushing them out of their own regional markets. European export subsidies, following other forms of indirect U.S. subsidies, brought world prices down to a level that was ruinous for farmers in countries unable to provide comparable subsidies. Export subsidies make the international market a dumping market.

2. The CAP Reform

After two years of debate, the MacSharrv reform was deprived of its initial good intentions concerning survival of small farms and limitation of intensification. The worst features survived. Its main points:

- * "Set aside" of 15% of cultivated land-Tu face ; *
- Price cuts of 30% on cereals, 15% on beef _;
- * Compensation payments: by area for cereals, by head for cattle and sheep ; *
- Pre-retirement compensation schemes for older farmers ;
- * Rural environment measures specific to certain zones whose implementation is entrusted to the Member States

The consequences were

- * For the European Union's budget, the advantage of budget planning several years in advance thanks to stable parameters such as surface and head of livestock ;
- * Competitive advantage for cheaper EU products on world markets :

A supposedly strengthened EU negotiating position in GATT thanks to reduction of subsidies .
- * Ongoing inequities in a system that provides the most substantial aids to the biggest farms and most productive regions
- * An ominous split between highly productive intensive agriculture that is hard on the environment and landscape maintenance on less productive lands
- * Ongoing or worsening environmental damage, the projected use of "set aside" lands for industrial non-food crops by intensive methods, without the check of chemical residue limits set for food [crops. is](#) an obvious aggravating factor.

3 How to reform the reform

The CAP reform proposed by the Green parties is designed to attain several important objectives

1. Full utilization of Europe's own food production resources, reducing imports of livestock feed from Third World countries, in order to enhance food security :

Development of environment-friendly agriculture over the Union's entire farming territory

3. Income parity between farmers and other categories of workers ;

Preservation and improvement of food quality

Safeguard of genetic diversity ;
6. Maintenance of a rural population sufficiently dense to preserve rural environments and thriving rural communities.

Proposals to implement this reform

1. Threshold prices for imports, fixed to correspond to socially and environmentally sustainable production costs within the European Union:

Remuneration of basic quantities of agricultural produce per region and farmer such as to ensure a viable income for small and medium-sized farmers ;
3. Abolition of export subsidies
4. Inclusion of cereal substitute products and cereals in the threshold price procedures to discourage their excessive import ;
5. Progressive switchover from chemically dependent intensive agriculture toward more sustainable, regionally adapted farming. To this end, a ban on all products from the list of pesticides, herbicides, fungicides and hormones known to be dangerous for health but still used in agriculture. and implementation of an eco-tax on remaining synthetic products to discourage their use ;
6. Aid for conversion to organic farming and to consumption of organic farm products in public establishments (hospitals, school and office canteens and cafeterias. etc.) ;
- i. Prohibition of all cruel methods of raising livestock, and of intensive livestock raising. Implementation of a ten-year reconversion program. on the Swiss model for laying hens. An information campaign on the negative aspects of meat consumption.
8. International fishery quotas under the aegis of the U.N. Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO, ensuring the position of regional and small-scale fisheries ;
9. Strict application of existing rules on animal welfare and the protection of species, particularly concerning a ban on hunting with non-selective methods and during the period of reproduction.

V. FITTING TRANSPORT INTO THE ENVIRONMENT

Ecological reconstruction is especially urgent in the field of transport. Traffic causes huge damage. At present, most social and environmental costs are not included in prices. The social burdens threaten to become heavier and heavier. The volume of traffic transporting merchandise is forecast to increase 50% by 2010. The restructuring of industry toward dispersed assembly plants, the creation of the European Economic Area, the opening of the Central and Eastern European countries and above all the completion of the Internal Market have all been accentuating this trend. The European Union plans to stimulate still more traffic by the project of transnational networks, almost entirely devoted to construction of yet another 12,000 km of freeways.

The Greens call for a radical shift away from freeways and air traffic, giving priority to combined rail- waterway- road transport. A decrease of superfluous mobility is required to stem ecological damage. Externalized social and environmental costs of all types of transport must be internalized, meaning higher prices for mobility of merchandise in particular. Greens want to see road transport reduced by 50%.

The Greens propose

- a. Reorientation of infrastructure policy toward transport by rail and waterways. Abolition of distortions that currently favor road and air transport :
- b. Development of a high speed train network parallel to reduction of continental air traffic and long distance automobile traffic. Existing tracks must be used for this network whenever possible : otherwise, new sites can be chosen only after impact assessment and consultation of concerned populations : when passing through urban areas, HST trains must slow down ;
- c. Banning of night flights to and from airports near residential areas. Adoption of VAT on air traffic and excise tax on kerosene. Surcharge on flights for distances below 1000 km ;
- d. Strict speed limits on freeways, roads and city streets. Equipment of trucks, buses and cars with speed limiters :
- e. Harmonization of social standards for transport work. adoption of a Directive on working hours for lorry drivers and airline personnel: preservation of railroad workers' social protection. Worldwide upgrading of seamen's social rights to combat social cost-cutting under flags of convenience ;
- f. Harmonization of maritime, road and air safety standards at the highest level, notably for transport of polluting and dangerous goods.

VI. PHASING OUT NUCLEAR ENERGY

Insecurity is an inescapable aspect of the nuclear complex, whether in regard to ecology, energy, economic factors or geopolitical considerations.

Only one strategy can effectively reduce this insecurity: the strategy of ending all military and civil nuclear operations within the framework of a general nuclear shut-down. The policy should be adopted for the entire European continent, East and West.

To define and carry out such a nuclear phase-out is possible only as key part of a broad new European energy policy.

The proposals to eliminate nuclear insecurity must therefore be formulated on two levels

*** General energy, policy**

1. Priorities of sustainable energy policy in Europe

It is important to work out and adopt a genuine European Union energy policy by the time the Maastricht Treaty comes up for review. The main obstacles to development of rational use of energy and renewable energy sources, and thus to dispensing with nuclear energy, are political and institutional rather than technical or economic. Therefore it is vital that the EU base its approach on

a. Real prices and costs of energy

Objective application of this principle would lead to significant reduction in subsidies granted to non-renewable energy sources and to an increase in their taxation, in order to reflect more accurately their social costs in terms of security, health and the environment.

b. Revision of research priorities and institutional structures

It is necessary to reverse the present hierarchy in order to favor significant funding of renewable energy sources and energy efficiency: new institutions must be set up at the European level, such as a European Agency for Renewable Sources of Energy, to underpin this vision.

c. Energy industry sector reforms

New regulations, in particular within the electricity sector, are needed to orient the energy industry's structures, objectives and working methods toward greater flexibility, decentralization and cost effectiveness.

d. Revitalization of the public sector as well as of local and regional associations

Local public authorities, working in conjunction with associations, are well-placed to promote energy-efficient policies in the fields of transport, housing, land development, waste management, public sector orders or consumer standards for certain types of equipment.

Measures to be adopted in the energy sector

A. Euratom Treaty revision

The Euratom Treaty must be revised as follows

- * Euratom's main mission becomes managing the phase-out of nuclear energy ;
- * radiation protection standards will be harmonized at the highest level of security, to meet the protection requirements of the most vulnerable segments of the population (foetuses, infants), and regularly revised to take into account the most exacting scientific recommendations ;
- * harmonization of standards will be obligatory, with an authorization and inspection system under EU authority, rather than the competence of Member States
- * an inspection and surveillance agency will be set up giving full power to inspectors under control of the European Parliament ;
- * nuclear questions will be handled in the framework of the co-decision procedure in conjunction with the European Parliament, in order to reduce the current democratic deficit in this area.

B. Third party liability

Third party liability of nuclear operators must be full and unlimited in order to cover all costs arising from eventual accidents occurring at the facility or during transport of nuclear matter, or occasioned by contaminated material.

C. End-of-cycle management of nuclear fuel

- * In accordance with the European Parliament's position. all programmes and activities. whether civil or military, for processing spent nuclear fuel for future [use, as](#) well as all operations linked to the manufacture of plutonium-based fuel (MOX), must be terminated

- * Irradiated fuel and nuclear waste must be treated at the facility that produced them and their transport prohibited. exceptions must be subject to impact study and democratic consent.

D. Research and Development

- * European budgets for energy l c D must reflect the new orientations of European energy policy, including-phase-out of nuclear energy. This means
 - * for nuclear fusion. cancellation of credits
 - * for nuclear fission, maintenance solely of funding for waste management operations, decommissioning and dismantling of installations. and more generally, all activities necessitated by phase-out as well as by compliance with relevant safety measures
 - * the budgets freed by this reconversion must be entirely allocated to energy savings and renewable sources of energy, taking into consideration the need for assistance in energy technology transfer to Eastern and Southern countries.

E. Nuclear proliferation

A halt to reprocessing and to all plutonium industry operations within the European Union would greatly contribute to limiting nuclear proliferation worldwide. The Union must play a more active role in stopping proliferation by using its influence in institutions (IAEA) and international negotiations -- primarily concerning the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) -- in favor of the following measures

- * prolongation of the NPT beyond 1995
- * cancellation of Articles IV and V of the NPT concerning development of atomic energy for peaceful purposes and the furtherance of peaceful nuclear explosions
- * safeguard clauses to be applied to all States without exception
- * conclusion of a comprehensive nuclear test ban treaty :
- * reform of the IAEA, with the aim of committing the organization wholly to efficient and full control and disposal of all fissile material used for civil or military purposes. and granting it the necessary powers and competence to carry out the task.

Within the framework of its privileged relations with Eastern European countries, the Union should give priority to drawing up a contract concerning safe disposal and storage of radioactive materials and waste accumulated in those countries.

F. A new framework for cooperation with Central and Eastern European countries and the Commonwealth of Independent States in the energy field -

The European Union, in compliance with its own programme of nuclear phase-out, must take a leading international role in ecologically and socially sound reconstruction of the former Eastern bloc countries' energy systems, excluding any recourse to nuclear energy.

To this end, the EU must actively support a four-year Nuclear Phase-out Plan for those countries, with priority to very rapid shutdown (within one year) of the most dangerous reactors (RBMK and YVER 440/230), followed by all YVER 4-10/213 and 1000, in that order.

This Plan should be based on active development of investments centered on rational use of energy, energy efficiency, combined production of heat and electricity, renovation of infrastructure for gas and electricity transport, modernization of traditional thermal power stations, construction of new high-performance natural gas and gasified coal-burning electricity generating plants (IGCC turbines), as well as renewable sources of energy.

In its implementation, the Plan must above all take care to call on local design and engineering skills and capacities, giving preference to formulas for financial and technological cooperation rather than to schemes to export know-how or "turnkey" installations.

With a view to setting up the Plan on an adequate institutional and financial footing, the EU must take the following initiatives

- * renegotiation of the European Energy Charter in order to state clearly its concerns in the fields of the environment, energy savings and renewable sources of energy, in particular reconsidering the protocol on nuclear energy in light of the objective to phase out nuclear energy
- * budgetary reconversion of the "Phare" and "Takis" ' programmes devoted to nuclear energy to conform to the new priorities, funding only shut-down operations involving nuclear power stations and sealing off the fuel cycle for safety reasons :
- * broadening the "Thermie" and "Joule" programmes to meet the Plan's objectives ;

- * putting pressure on international financial institutions concerned (EBRD, BEI, World Bank) to modify criteria governing allocation of loans to the energy sector in former Eastern bloc countries so as to promote investments in the field of energy efficiency
- * allocation of a share of revenues from the Union tax on CO₂ emissions and energy to contribute to funding the Plan (a minimum base of 10 billion ECUs is to be considered) ,
- * launching of an urgent appeal to members of the G24, requesting them to increase their own contribution to the multilateral security fund, while redefining its objective so as to bring it in line with the Plan.

VII, ACHIEVING ENVIRONMENTALLY SUSTAINABLE LEVELS OF PRODUCTION AND CONSUMPTION

The European Environmental Agency must draw up a European Environmental Plan for achieving environmentally sustainable levels of production and consumption in Europe within a single generation. Emissions of all major polluting substances will have to be reduced by 70 to 90% within the next 30 years. Intermediate five-year goals must also be set. The ten most pressing environmental problems need to be attacked.

Stop climate change

To fight the greenhouse effect, Greens are not satisfied with the official EU aim of stabilization in 2000. We are struggling for a 20% reduction in the EU of the most important greenhouse gas, carbon dioxide, by the year 2000, to be followed by a 50% reduction in 2010 compared with 1990 levels. Only if the rich part of the planet reduces its greenhouse gas emissions is a worldwide stabilization possible around 2000. Through a combination of a European energy saving programme and a gradually increasing energy/carbon tax reaching a level of at least \$20 per barrel of oil in the year 2000, this aim of 20% reduction can be achieved.

Retain biodiversity

Every year, plant and animal species disappear forever from Europe, impoverishing our nature and heritage. Two thousand European plant species are endangered. To stop the loss of diversity of biological species, their habitats and fragile ecosystems must be protected. Conservation areas should cover at least 30% of the whole of Europe by the year 2000. At least 10% should be strictly protected. Forestry in Europe is based on monoculture and the use of heavy technology. Sustainable forestry practices must be generalized and the old original European forest specifically protected.

Toxic waste

The natural environment is being polluted by dispersion of toxic substances such as pesticides, radioactive substances, heavy metals and chlorine-containing poly-aromatic hydrocarbons. These toxic substances are poisonous to plants, animals and humankind. Several programmes are needed to overcome this problem. Export of toxic waste outside the EU must be totally banned. In particular, it is urgent to implement a strategy of conversion of the chlorine industry so as to eliminate all discharges of chlorinated organic substances into the environment.

Waste disposal

The European Union must start treating waste as an environmental problem and not as merchandise. The Green approach is (1) prevention, (2) reuse and (3) recycling. A Union tax on waste is only a necessary first step.

Stop squandering resources

The earth is finite. Resources of fossil fuels and raw materials are limited as well. A fossil-free scenario is our long term aim. Energy conservation and renewable energies like solar, wind, hydropower and biomass are the answer. Natural gas and gas obtained from coal will help to make a clean transition to a fossil fuel free society.

Reduction, reuse and recycling of materials is the answer to the need to limit use of raw materials. Producers must be made responsible for the whole life cycle of their products. Quotas on extraction and use of some natural resources may be necessary to protect scarce resources from total depletion.

Prevent holes in the ozone layer

The EU should seek rapid revision of the Montreal/London/Copenhagen Protocol to gain worldwide agreement to stop production of all chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs), as well as of halons and other ozone depleting substances as soon as possible. The Union must set a good example by stopping production of all these ozone depleting substances immediately and carefully destroying those that exist.

Stop acid rain

In parts of Europe, especially the United Kingdom, the Netherlands, Germany, Poland and the Czech Republic, the yearly acid loads for the atmosphere are 30 times higher than the natural load of 200 acid units per year. In the EU, 80% of the land must bear more than the 'critical acid load' of 400 acid units. Severe green taxes on sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides are necessary (Sweden already taxes sulphur).

Stop algae proliferation

The spread of algae **is** due to excess use of plant nutrients, phosphate and nitrates. The main causes are manure, fertilizers and different forms of waste. The remedies are organic farming and proper waste management policy.

Noise disturbance

The primary cause of noise disturbance is the increase of road and air traffic. A European tax on noise of airplanes, lorries and other motor vehicles is required.

Smog

Summer smog is mainly caused by man-made emissions, especially cars and to a lesser extent organic solvents. A 90% reduction in emissions of Volatile Organic Compounds (VOC) and in damaging emissions from organic solvents by the year 2000 can eliminate summer smog. Winter smog is caused by similar man-made emissions as well as by small particles whose emissions are not well documented, but primary sources are industrial processes, power generation, space heating and motor cars. Special prevention programmes for small particles are needed.

The means to solve these environmental problems are the following

Prices have to speak the ecological truth, they have to incorporate all social and environmental costs. One way of doing this is to create a system of eco-taxes on non-renewable energy, scarce resources and environmentally harmful activities. Reusable, repairable and recyclable products must be encouraged. Producers must be made responsible for their products "from the cradle to the grave". Eco-labelling, with participation of environmental groups, is another instrument. All private and public firms must be required to conduct annual environmental audits. Environmental impact assessments, with the participation of individual citizens and environmental organizations, will be made compulsory and must include a so-called 'zero option'. European law must provide individual citizens with free access to information on the state of the environment from private and public authorities.

VIII. NORTH-SOUTH: COOPERATING FOR ECO-DEVELOPMENT WITH THIRD WORLD COUNTRIES

The Maastricht Treaty which went into force in November 1993 for the first time includes cooperation among the Europe Union's common policies and calls for harmonization of national policies in this field.

Today, it must be observed that Union aid as such to Third World countries is not subject to real democratic control and remains marginal in terms of its budget

- * The budget of the European Fund for Development which finances the Lomé Convention -- a pillar of EU cooperation policy -- remains in the hands of the Member States; the Commission and the Council play the main role, jointly defining the meagre Union budget.

*EU aid represents only 12% of all aid from Member States and 3.5% of overall aid. This percentage has remained unchanged for the last ten years. Over a fifth of this aid takes the form of food aid which serves mainly to get rid of EU Farm surpluses.

Reorienting the policy of the Union towards eco-development, as suggested by the Green Parties, must of course be concretized in choices regarding cooperation and by way of all the policies of the Union affecting North-South relations. The EU should promote fair and stable prices for raw materials which are of special interest to many Southern countries.

Based on recognition that what is called development aid can rectify the imbalance between North and South only if accompanied by a general revision of international relations, and considering that all action should be guided by the saving, "taking less is better than giving more", the Greens propose the following ten measures

1. coordinate national development policies so as better to transform relationships left over from the colonial period and center development aid on combatting poverty and contributing to self-reliance
2. focus on achieving and carrying out a Union agreement whereby each member State agrees to devote 1 % of its GNP to development aid by the year 2000
3. make sure that 50% of projects favor women in developing countries, which means that these projects must focus on meeting the primary needs of the population, with special attention to effects of development projects on children:
4. redistribute aid geographically and socially to ensure that it reaches the poorest populations, which implies transforming the Generalized Preferential System so as to improve access of the moderately advanced nations to the Common Market
5. halt all structural food aid and limit food shipments to providing emergency relief, essentially on the basis of triangular operations (EU-financed delivery of surpluses from one Southern country to another Southern country suffering from shortages) ;
6. implement European legislation prohibiting the obligation to purchase products and services from the country supplying aid

7. integrate the European Development Fund for Lomé into the EU budget, to bring it under control of the European Parliament
8. reform the Stabex system on the basis of the following criteria
 - priority for the poorest countries ;
 - direct allocation of aid funds to producers ;
9. institutionalize EU support for initiatives promoting alternative trade :
10. set up effective judicial review of the application of the above criteria to all agreements entered into between the European Union and developing nations.

Modify international relations

A number of problems which jeopardize the very future of the South, some in a potentially decisive manner, and which hinder eco-development. must be tackled actively by the EU, either in the context of its own policies (notably trade policies) or within the framework of international organizations (UN, GATT, World Bank, IMF) in which the EU plays an important political role.

1 - Cancel ACP debt

Cancellation of the debt of the African, Caribbean and Pacific (ACP) countries must be scheduled in the following manner

- * overall negotiations based on the principle of joint Northern responsibility:
- * a freeze on assets held in Europe by political leaders who have enriched themselves illicitly at the expense of poor countries ;
- * enquiry into reserves set aside in Northern banks for unpaid debt ;
- * immediate, unconditional cancellation of the poorest countries' debts.

2 - Fight poverty and promote respect for human rights

- * Effective compliance with human rights standards requires meeting basic needs of populations to food, housing, education and medical care.
- * Eradication of illiteracy and education programmes are effective ways to stimulate the population's participation in democracy.
- * Democracy must be the only condition required by creditors. replacing economic conditions (such as structural adjustment requirements of institutional creditors) which remove the necessary means of public social expenditure required to build the foundations of democracy, and human rights.

3 - Proscribe authoritarianism in the field of birth control

Since the right to sexuality and to reproduction is an inalienable human right, the EU must ban any attempt to link development aid to implementation of a policy on birth control.

It should on the other hand contribute to :

- * guaranteeing universal access, free of charge and not based on any form of discrimination, to sex education and a whole range of sure, safe and effective methods of contraception as well as related health services
- * eliminating all standards, rules and procedures which constitute a hindrance to the provision of information and the free choice of these methods of contraception.

4. - Guarantee the dignity of indigenous populations

No project involving indigenous populations or carried out on their territory may be initiated without recognition of their rights, prior consultation and joint management. The EU must recognize such indigenous populations as their partners. notably

- * by concretizing the Council's decision of December 1992 to promote the rights of ethnic minorities :
- * by including a clause on the rights of indigenous populations in contracts and treaties

IX ELIMINATING SOCIAL EXCLUSION

Many people in the European Union are marginalized. Social exclusion is escalating dangerously, aggravated by long-term unemployment. More than 18 million persons in the EU are currently unemployed, and within a few months, the figure will have risen by another three million. No less than fifty million persons in the EU are living below the poverty level. The gap between rich regions and poor or peripheral regions is deepening. The 1988 Cecchini report promise of five million additional jobs thanks to completion of the Single Market is only a vague memory. And now the latest Delors White Paper pins all hopes on traditional economic growth and more competition on global markets.

For the Greens, the objective of work for all is an essential priority. It must determine the entire economic and social policy. In the framework of proposals for eco-development, we support the creation of new activities, meeting needs that are so far unsatisfied or unpaid, as well as better redistribution of work.

Up to now. EU social policy has been sharply limited. partly because of the diversity of the systems and traditions in the Member States. But mainly it is the combination of a lack of political will, the weak position of the EP and the required unanimity in certain decisions which makes it hostage of a single obstructionist government.

The Greens urge a drastically new approach to restore the vitality of the European welfare state and to eliminate social exclusion. The Greens criticize blind economic growth, because it is pursued at the expense of the environment and does not solve the problem of unemployment. Our aim is not to stop economic growth, but to change its direction and content. A new way of development is needed: "sustainable development" or simply eco-development as we prefer to call it.

In the most polluting sectors, green transformation of the economy would indeed mean loss of jobs. However, it will also create many new jobs, especially in environmental industries. Most often, it will involve a change of employment. for instance from nuclear energy toward use of renewable sources, from industrial to organic farming.

More new jobs can be promoted by making labour cheaper by a shift of the tax burden from labour onto capital, energy and scarce raw materials. Furthermore, paid labour must be redistributed so as to contribute to a fair division of paid and unpaid work between men and women.

The needed renewal of the social security system should include individual rights for each person, independent from relations to other persons. We reject current attempts to dismantle the welfare state in order to "stay competitive". To put it plainly: a good social security system is expensive. but well worth the price in taxes and contributions.

The Greens propose

- a. Creation of new "ecological" jobs in such sectors as renewable energy, recycling, public transport, depollution of soil and water; and the reorientation of agriculture policy so as to maintain farming and other rural employment.
- b. General reduction of working hours in various forms: a four-day work week of 35 hours, promotion of part-time work; no restrictions on the voluntary choice of part-time work and guaranteed equal rights for part-time workers. The EU must stimulate the evolution toward a society where the available amount of work is distributed more equally.
- c. Establishment of an industrial policy aiming to encourage and spread clean lines of production, technologies and products. Phasing-out of industrial sectors incompatible with ecological development (nuclear power plants. chlorine chemistry, arms production) and conversion of other sectors such as automobiles, packaging, the chemical industry.

- d. Extension of such essential public services as education, public health, day-care. The EU must establish framework guaranteeing a sufficient level of public services at local and regional level, including those in peripheral regions.
- e. Support and development of local initiatives to set up cooperatives and to start enterprises in suburban and rural districts.
- f. Introduction in all Member States either of minimum wages as well as minimum levels of assistance to persons without means of subsistence, or of guaranteed basic income, linked in each case to the average wage in that Member State, to ensure existence above the poverty line.
- σ Total equivalence of treatment between men and women concerning access to the job market, wages and social security rights.
- h. Revision of the relevant articles in the Economic and Monetary Union to include full employment and fair income distribution as objectives for the 1996 stage.
- i. Setting minimum social protection levels by qualified majority instead of unanimity in the Council, in co-decision with the European Parliament.
- j. Actions at international level (EU, UN, GATT) to prevent social and environmental dumping, Inclusion of the International Labour Organization (ILO) social clause in all trade agreements. The EU as such must ratify the ILO Convention, the European Convention on Human Rights and the Social Charter of the Council of Europe (currently undergoing revision).
- k. Transformation of the new loan mechanism of the European Investment Fund and the European Investment Bank for financing regional eco-development projects, industrial conversion, promotion of the non-commercial sector and environmental protection. The EU must support the right to housing by a policy of privileged loans for home renovation and social housing construction.
- l. Establishment of European enterprise councils in multinational organizations not only for the sake of information flow, but also to make possible genuine participation of employees at the European level.

X. USING MONETARY POLICY FOR EUROPE, NOT VICE VERSA

The Maastricht Treaty stresses the creation of a single currency as the main means of uniting Europe. However, as set forth, the forced march to a single currency seems more likely to split Europe. Trying to create a single currency even before the EU has a solid social dimension is irresponsible and implies ceding absolute priority to price stability. The reasonable aim of keeping inflation under control must be pursued in combination with other social and economic objectives such as employment, social security, international solidarity and ecological reconstruction.

Rather than by creating new monetary institutions. Europe must be brought together by seeking genuine convergence between the different economies within the EU. Indicators such as per capita, income, the rate of exclusion and the environmental debt are of importance. A single currency calls for increased transfers to the weaker regions. transfers the rich regions are so far not inclined to pay. Meanwhile, the catastrophic experience with the overly, hasty, monetary union in Germany enforces Greens' skepticism.

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EU Member States are involved in an international competition to decrease taxation of commerce. Capital [especially. as](#) well as world trade in merchandise, is succeeding in avoiding paying a fair share of the tax burden at the expense of labour, local production and consumption. Only EU standards for national taxes can lead to balanced distribution of the tax burden.

The Greens propose

1. Priority to new convergence criteria such as per capita GNP, rate of social exclusion and environmental debt.
2. Development of economic programmes which are specific to the various Member States, or to Regions, enabling the weakest to overcome their structural handicaps, and not general application of austerity measures. Economic policies must show real flexibility, allowing the necessary adjustments in accordance with national and regional particularities. Ways and means: together with different deadlines must be granted to those countries which require them. A reduction in budget deficits and strict price stability do not constitute our top priority. The point of monetary policy is not to achieve zero inflation but to keep inflation under control.
3. Drawing up regulations for financial markets to limit financial speculation generated by free circulation of capital, in order to prevent wild fluctuations in exchange rates bearing no relation to the real state of national economies.
4. Fiscal harmonization within the EU going beyond mere mutual recognition of national legislation, mainly in the field of corporate taxation in order to prevent relocation of companies for purposes of fiscal dumping.

Review of regional structural policies aimed at developing a common budgetary policy to meet the needs of real [convergence. in](#) line with reorientation of the economy towards ecologically sound development.

6. A common budgetary policy taking into consideration not only expenses but also levels of income. Mechanisms for fiscal equalization to reduce excessive economic imbalances between regions must be envisaged, together with implementation of the Green Parties' proposal concerning a tax on energy and CO2 emissions. A centralized budget must be used to cushion monetary shocks to vulnerable regions that would otherwise exacerbate regional differences, contrary to the aim of strengthening Union-wide social and economic coherence.

7. Preservation of the possibility of periodically readjusting rates, while remaining within the European Monetary System, in order to attain the level of flexibility called for by structural adjustments without exposure to risk of uncontrolled exchange rates. A single currency and Central European Bank may emerge as the outcome of this process, but not of a forced march that most Member States are unable to follow.
8. Measures against tax evasion and money laundering, such as revision of banking secrecy rules.

XI. EUROPEAN CITIZENSHIP: OPENING TO THE OUTSIDE WORLD

The Maastricht Treaty introduces the notion of "citizenship of the Union", substantially limiting innovations to questions dealing with the right to vote. The Greens, however, are also strongly concerned with other matters such as free movement, immigration and the right to asylum.

Both the method envisaged to deal with these matters and their formulation appear inadequate. The promised, but still lagging, removal of frontiers to allow free movement of persons is in fact a relaxation of controls applying only to citizens of the Member States. No initiative is planned to extend free movement to the approximately nine million citizens of non-EU countries residing legally in the Union.

As for the fight against drugs and crime, police or customs cooperation, or legal and penal cooperation, all have two common characteristics: they are based on an exclusively repressive approach and are handled in utmost secrecy by intergovernmental agencies, most frequently by civil servants who are not democratically accountable for their [decisions](#), in particular not to the European Parliament.

European citizenship must be based on the following principles .:

1. Citizenship of the Union is not a closed concept. While citizens of one Member State automatically become citizens of the Union, citizens of third countries who have legally resided in an EU country for three to five years must be able to have easy access to citizen status in the country of their residence, together with Union citizenship, while at the same time they should also be allowed to retain the nationality of their country of origin (double nationality).

Legal residents from third countries who do not have or do not yet have European nationality must be guaranteed as to their fundamental rights, including freedom of movement (Article 8A of the EU Treaty), thanks to a European Resident Card.

3. Residents must also be able to benefit from a series of specific rights, notably regarding reuniting of families, access to work, professional training, administrative independence for women, political rights and electoral rights for local elections. To this end, a framework Directive must be drawn up and adopted concerning the status of residents from non-EU countries.

Right to asylum and refugee status

The right to asylum must be recognized as a fundamental right of the individual and respected in all EU countries. Overly detailed measures adopted to obstruct its application must be revoked. Every asylum-seeker has a right to have his or her request duly taken into consideration and to be treated in a dignified and correct way while the case is being considered. People fleeing from war situations including civil war, racism, sexual mass violence and other forms of persecution, as well as from natural or ecological catastrophes, should have access to refugee status and benefit from the necessary assistance and protection in the framework of European solidarity.

Immigration

The European Union must not become a fortress. After the fall of the Berlin wall, it is necessary to prevent the construction of new walls made of controls and police surveillance. The Greens do not go along with the paranoid philosophy of arrangements such as the Schengen agreement. but rather urge the EU to opt for a truly human immigration policy.

Individual rights in the European Union

Individual rights are not always respected in Europe. Discrimination is becoming an everyday reality. This is why Greens demand that the EU should guarantee non-discrimination. notably for people who by their nationality, ethnic identity, sexual preference, philosophical or religious convictions, handicap or illness, condition as prisoner, conscientious objector, asylum-seeker, etc.. are more exposed than others to discrimination or even ill treatment.

Fighting drugs

The war on drugs having proved to be a [failure](#), in the short run it would be appropriate to promote policies of damage control to reduce risks linked to [drugs](#), by providing social care for addicts, syringe replacement and availability of substitute products. It is also necessary to envisage going beyond prohibitionism, promoting a law system to revise the UN Convention on Drugs to defeat first of all big criminal organizations that traffic in drugs, profiting from the failure of the present approach. Racism and the extreme right

The rise of racism and the extreme right in Europe constitutes a real threat to persons and to democracy. Racist crimes and offenses too often go unpunished, their victims forgotten. The authorities must give priority to preventing and combatting every form of intolerance and provide the necessary protection for potential or actual victims of racist acts. The best antidote to racism is integration and suppression of incrimination against differences. The Greens are for an open society, multicultural and multiethnic.

European cooperation in the fields of justice and internal affairs

European common policy in all these matters should be elaborated with the participation and consent of the national and European parliaments and be subject to adequate democratic control. Such eminently sensitive matters concerning individual rights cannot be dealt with by mere interministerial agreements (such as the ad hoc immigration group) or international conventions (such as the Schengen, Dublin and Interpol accords).

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Cultural identity

European identity is characterized by interaction of different cultures: diversity, complexity and permanent change are the key words. The role of the European Union is to encourage cultural exchange and to protect and develop cultural diversity, with the special task of supporting minority languages. The Greens' proposal to include cultural development among regional funding objectives was adopted by the European Parliament, but not vet by the Council and the Commission.

Media

In Europe, the media landscape is losing diversity and quality in a process of concentration and commercialization. To ensure diversity, Europe's audiovisual production must be promoted.

XII. PROMOTING GENDER EQUALITY

In the needed transformation of society, it is essential for women to obtain the right of self-determination, including individual status within the social security system. For all their differences, a common denominator of the Member States is the unequal position of the sexes. Discrimination on the basis of gender must be combatted in all spheres of social and cultural life

The Equal Opportunities Unit of the European Commission obstructs regional projects for affirmative action on ideological grounds of free competition. The Greens reject this position. In collaboration with the European Women's Network and the European Women's Lobby, the Green Group in the European Parliament will pursue a policy of affirmative discrimination for women in all fields. This entails:

1. Equality between women and men and full democratic participation of women in all sectors of society ;

Until both sexes reach equality, there should be affirmative action using such devices as quotas to achieve participation of women in public and private fields. Women must receive equal pay for equal work. Women's entrance into the higher echelons of salaried employment must be ensured

3. Integration of women into the paid work force must be a priority for the Structural Funds ;
4. Female immigrants must be granted individual residence permits, independent of family or marital status ;

Women's rights must be included in association and cooperation treaties. excluding any acceptance of extra-territorial enforcement in Europe of customary or religious restrictions on the rights of immigrant women.

XIII. DEMOCRATIZING EUROPEAN INSTITUTIONS

The Greens are in favor of European integration. The European Union -- despite all the well-deserved criticism, and even if it cannot accomplish pan-European integration on its own -- will be an important factor in this process. The four key concepts of the needed reform are : a pan-European approach. democracy. social ecology and decentralization.

The Maastricht Treaty put the Union on quite another track. It strengthened the intergovernmental structure rather than the co-decision process involving the European Parliament. The secret conclaves of the twelve national delegations in COREPER and of the various Councils of Ministers further erode the effective control of the national parliaments over their governments.

It is urgent to adopt new initiatives to give renewed impetus to a Union which has become bogged down and is incapable of taking positive joint action on behalf of its own citizens and in accordance with its worldwide responsibilities.

The treaties have been based from the outset on the theory of free exchange. closely linked to business. and on the intergovernmental approach. both of which need to be called sharply into question.

The Union's objectives

The European [Union. as](#) envisaged by the Green Parties, must be made up of democratic countries committed to guaranteeing and developing democratic freedoms and promoting eco-development. solidarity and justice throughout the world.

1. Foreign policy : Development of a truly democratic common foreign policy must be an essential objective of the European Union sought by the Greens. This foreign policy must not result in the creation of a new military bloc, nor must it depend on parallel organizations such as the WEU or on military alliances such as NATO.

development for **all** the world's populations. improvements in trade and international relations,

2. Domestic policy : The Union must ensure harmonious development of society in a context of balanced relations with the rest of the world, based on: equitable and ecological use of natural resources, gradual elimination of imbalances between the Regions, constant promotion~.of the quality of life.

Institutions to remedy the democratic dericrit

At present, the Union's legislative power is not clearly separate from its executive power; its decision-making system is complex, applying a whole range of different procedures to various fields without any clear rationale, and resulting in extraordinary ambiguity regarding the role of Union authorities.

The Parliament is not a full-fledged legislative body; the Commission has both legislative and executive competences: the Council is simultaneously a government, a legislator and a diplomatic conference. the Court of Justice is not a real constitutional court.

A democratic European Union needs a transparent structure. The construction of three separate 'pillars' in the Maastricht Treaty is in itself an obstacle to democracy. Moreover, regulations that lend themselves to unverifiable spending, misuse of power and fraud damage trust in the political system.

The Greens propose

- a. Along with enlargement of the European Union to the EFTA countries, a time schedule should be set for step-by-step entry of the Visegrad States (the Czech Republic, Slovakia, Hungary and Poland). Entry should be subject to referendum in the applicant country.
- b. The European Parliament constitutes with the Council the legislative and budgetary authority of the European Union. The Parliament must have power to initiate legislation, as well as the power of political control over the Commission.
- c. The European Parliament must be elected according to a uniform electoral procedure of the proportional type.
- d. Modification of the Treaty, admission of new Member States, enlargement of the competence of the Union and approval of the Constitution should require qualified majorities in both the Parliament and the Council. An EU-wide referendum should be held on the Treaty to be revised in 1996.
- e. The Committee of the Regions. established by the Maastricht Treaty, must be made up of democratically elected representatives of the regions.

- f. A constitutional meeting must be set up by the European Parliament and the national and regional parliaments to contribute to the carefully-prepared constitution Europe needs.
- g. The Court of Justice should be competent to rule on all legal acts of the Union. Regions must be able to have recourse to the Court in the fields of their competence.
- h. Public control by the European Court of Auditors must be strengthened. Regulations that favor fraud and corruption must be simplified. Party finances must be open and transparent, under public control.

XIV. ENLARGING THE UNION

Greens are convinced that the European Union should remain open to all peoples and all democratic countries of Europe, in keeping with the political aim of establishing a democratic and peaceful Union among all European people and countries.

Especially after the fall of the Berlin wall, more and more countries have shown their desire to take part in the construction of an integrated Europe, even if citizens have not always been fully involved in the decisions as to what a European Union should be and do.

The serious limits of the existing Union must be urgently addressed, especially in view of the enlargement to new members. The persistence of the democratic deficit, the insufficient and misleading information to the public as to decision-making on the European level, the insufficiencies in the social, fiscal, environmental, transport and other fields become especially evident in view of the admission of new members

That is why Greens are very critical of the way in which the negotiations for enlargement of the Union to Austria, Finland, Norway and Sweden have been opened and conducted. We regret the pressure and haste characterizing the negotiation process. In these conditions, it is difficult to have an open and clear debate before the referenda in the applicant countries on the political engagement that admission to the Union requires and on the concrete conditions for membership. We consider that it was irresponsible on the part of the Council of Ministers to set in motion the process of enlarging the Union without at the same time committing itself to a process of democratizing the institutions of the Union and ensuring their transparency.

We reaffirm our fundamental criticism of a vision of European integration oriented solely toward creation of a vast market and limited to economically developed countries; the enlargement of the Community cannot take place solely on the basis of economic parameters.

The enlargement of the European Union should not be limited to the EFTA countries. As was the case for Greece, Spain and Portugal, joining the Union can be an important instrument of democratic and economic stabilization of the countries of Central, Eastern and Southern Europe.

But this process cannot take place without giving special care to the following aspects:

- * respect for human rights should remain a strict condition for joining the European Union ;
- * opening the Union market to Central and Eastern European products must be accompanied by a deliberate policy aimed at overcoming ecological and social imbalances between East and West.

The Greens propose

- a. That equal treatment be accorded to the examination of applications regardless of the size, economic weight or strategic importance of the respective applicant countries ;
- b. That negotiations for enlarging the Union to include the four countries of the Visegrad group take place on the basis of the priority defined above ;
- c. That the transfer of competence from the national to the European level and the transformation of the Community into a Union of the federal type go hand in hand with a process of decentralization and transfer of competences from States to Regions ;
- d. That the Union seize the occasion of the negotiations underway to review with the applicant countries existing Community legislation on environmental protection with a view to alignment at the highest possible levels of protection. The Union should be ready to modify its level achieved ("acquis") where the legislation of applicant countries is more strict ;
- e. That "opting out" clauses in fields of Community competence be eliminated to ensure the internal cohesion of the enlarged Union
- f. That a common foreign policy be established independent of existing military alliances, to allow neutral countries to participate fully ;
- σ That a European Constitution be adopted in order to overcome the ambiguities of the Maastricht Treaty and to offer to all the peoples of Europe the possibility of choosing with full awareness and freely joining in a project of democratic Union, rather than in a vast market regulated by intergovernmental procedures. In this context, the draft Constitution recently elaborated by the European Parliament can be considered a useful start.

XV. ACHIEVING COMMON SECURITY

Peace is indivisible

Security has for too long been exclusively linked to military balances of power and the use of coercion and violence to solve international conflicts. But security can no longer be defined solely in military terms. The European Greens start with a larger, comprehensive concept of security, which takes into account social, economic, ecological, psychological and cultural aspects. Thus our policies concentrate on the prevention of armed conflicts, on removing the causes of war and on the developing of peaceful conflict resolution. Investment into combatting racism, in understanding and respecting other cultures, and above all else, ending global poverty would be Europe's strongest and most effective long-term security plan.

Peace must be organized

- * Both within Europe and globally there are many common problems which could easily lead to new armed conflicts. The problems of environmental degradation, frontier, ethnic and national rivalry, resource shortages and the proliferation of weaponry, are inextricably related and must therefore be tackled in an organised way. It is also clear that social change and respect for international law cannot be imposed by military force, but must be accepted by consent.
- * Neutral countries can play a vital role as a place for negotiations, information and active conflict prevention. They can play this role even better because of their increased independence of military interests. Neutrality must be combined with active solidarity, conflict prevention and non military conflict resolution. We are advocating a cooperative security system based on non-military means in which neutral countries can willingly participate.
- * To prevent war we must organise for peace. Instead of the creation of a European military superpower, as envisaged by the Maastricht Treaty, the European Greens will develop cooperative security structures in several fields and on several levels: local, regional, national and international. This will require the transfer of some national funds and competencies to international and regional bodies.
- * The main security objectives of the European Greens in the coming decade are:
 - a, to nourish freedom and democracy .
 - b. to narrow the gap between rich and poor ;
 - c. fair distribution and sustainable use of natural resources :

- e. creation of a pan-European security system capable of the prevention, management and resolution of disputes without recourse to violence ;
- f. general and complete disarmament as advocated by the United Nations.

A new European security system

1. The end of the Cold War presents new challenges. Territorial, ethnic, and economic conflicts threaten peace and security. The changes in Central and Eastern Europe have led to various problems which in some countries include economic chaos, massive unemployment, shortage of consumer goods, dismantling of government provisions, great social unrest and growing nationalistic or chauvinistic tendencies. The former Soviet troops have not yet been completely pulled out from foreign countries, and military threat is still used as an indirect argument in negotiations. In the post Cold War era Europe is more plagued by armed conflict than ever before since the Second World War.

The most violent conflicts are being fought in the Balkans and the Caucasus. For all its proclamations, the EU was unable to elaborate a common foreign policy, let alone to play a consistent role for peace. There was scarcely any real effort to exert peaceful forms of influence, notably through support for local peace [movements](#), to ensure enforcement of the embargo or to mobilize substantial peace-keeping forces. In the case of Bosnia-Herzegovina this amounts to a betrayal of the people, especially the very large proportion who have continued despite everything to maintain a multi-ethnic society. The EU and UN negotiators were all too willing to acquiesce in the country's division along ethnic lines. The Greens urge recognition and protection of the right of the legal government of Bosnia-Herzegovina to a viable state and the provision of sufficient UNPROFOR troops to ensure safe areas. Active assistance must be given to all those throughout former Yugoslavia who support human rights, democracy and dialogue against chauvinism and ethnic cleansing.

No single European institution can be expected to address these problems, but the systems "interlocking institutions" currently being developed is seriously flawed due to the dominance of Western European defence interests (NATO and WEU). These have commanded almost unlimited resources while peacekeeping and the prevention of conflict have been effectively ignored.

3. We want to abolish NATO and WEU - which have failed to produce a fresh strategy to match the dramatically changed international situation - and to replace them with a pan-European collective security system, comprising all European countries, which is prepared to deal with the prevention, managing and solving of conflicts between and within member states. In this system security policy is subject to full parliamentary control and aimed in the first place at the minimizing of violence when solving conflicts. All types of settlement should be institutionalized by means of a binding treaty: inquiry, mediation,

good offices, conciliation, arbitration, and jurisdiction. To keep the peace, once arrangements have been made between the fighting parties, sending in peace-keeping forces under the command of the UN is accepted by the Greens.

The best way to reach this aim is the structural development of the Conference on Security and Cooperation in Europe (CSCE) into a 'regional security organisation', as mentioned in article 32 et seq. of the UN Charter. The final determination of the CSCE territory as a European collective security system will depend on the creation of other regional security systems.

4. If the CSCE is to function properly, it must have funds which reflect serious commitment to the goals of confidence building, conflict prevention and democracy. Its current budget of around \$3 million is a tiny fraction of NATO's. We therefore propose the transfer of the NATO budget, resources and assets to the CSCE. By the year 2000 we expect the CSCE to be the primary European security system and NATO to have been voluntarily dissolved.
5. In the long term the European Greens do not envisage a role for national armed forces. Meanwhile, apart for self-defence, national capabilities should not be used independently, but only if mandated by the CSCE or by the UN.
6. The increasing European cooperation should not lead to further degradation of the Third World's position. European politics do not take place in the East-West dimension alone. Many European problems can not be isolated from the North-South dimension of world affairs. A primary question of European security is the relationship of Europe with the Mediterranean area and with the Middle East. Both areas involve problems which should be solved by means of a cooperative approach. The establishment of a 'fortress Europe' from a political, economic and military point of view would only strengthen conflict patterns and make Europe's security concerns more complex.

Mediterranean problems should be resolved at a Conference for Security and Cooperation in the Mediterranean. This conference should deal with common security, conflict mediation and resolution, economic cooperation, migration, human rights and ecological security.

Disarmament

1. Nuclear weapons have no role to play in a green Europe. The theory of nuclear deterrence would entitle all countries to have nuclear weapons. A comprehensive Test Ban Treaty and nuclear disarmament by France, the UK, Russia, Ukraine and Belarus are urgent priorities.
2. We aim to control, reduce and eventually eliminate European exports of all military, nuclear and other repressive technology, and to persuade non-European countries to do the same. We will oppose state promotion of arms exports and spending on military research and development.

3. The CSCE also has a central role to play in the ongoing European arms control and disarmament process, supported by integrated CSCE institutions for verification and conversion management. In the CSCE Security Forum we will seek for concrete measures to be aimed at:
 - a. complete ban of nuclear, biological and chemical arms. The greatest menace at the moment is the risk-that nuclear and other arms for mass destruction are spread. All nuclear testing will be prohibited and all arms for mass destruction be placed under UN control, to be destroyed afterwards ;
 - b. harmonisation of the various arms control obligations already concluded;
 - c, deeper cuts in conventional arms and military spending, restructuring remaining conventional forces to defensive military doctrines ;
 - d. promotion of multilateral reductions in arms sales and cooperation in respect of non-proliferation of all categories of weapons
 - e. cooperation in converting the defense industry to civil production.

Guarantees for democratic rights

- * It is our aim that the terms of multilateral treaties on human rights will be incorporated in national laws ;
- * Each member of the CSCE shall submit to a supranational judicial regime regarding democratic and human rights, which would have a significant impact on its lawmaking process.

Civil society : towards a Europe of Regions

The common security system process will not be limited to the institutional level: contacts between people within and between countries - within a framework of a Europe of Regions - are necessary to find sustainable solutions to many of Europe's pressing problems. An Assembly of European Regions will be de-veloped as a citizens' forum within the CSCE. The CSCE should not be merely a club of diplomats and generals: NGOs should be recognised as partners in the CSCE process. They should be allowed to speak in the CSCE meetings and have access to all documentation and proposals as soon as they are tabled.

Reform of the United Nations

1. The UN must be made more democratic, and thus enabled to play a central role in promoting integrated regional peace and developments programmes. We will campaign for the reform of the Security Council to reflect the global regions, and the veto to be abolished. Decisions shall be taken by qualified majority.

2. The European Greens stress the necessity of a constabulary role of the UN in order to prevent further armed escalation of a conflict ('peace keeping'). The objective of all forms of intervention must always be to start a process leading to a solution **Of** the conflict rather than to the freezing of the conflict
3. We will also press for the establishment of
 - a. UN centres for conflict resolution, with mediation teams trained in all cultural and religious backgrounds, to monitor conflict areas and bring their skills to bear before violence breaks out :
 - b. a UN Verification Agency for early warning and treaty verification procedures.